

BT Indirect Channels



The Essential Guide to Telemarketing

Identifying your customers

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Guide to Telemarketing – An Introduction

Telemarketing, unlike many other forms of marketing communications, involves two way human interaction.

Not only can telemarketing articulate your business proposition to a targeted audience, it can be used to gather feedback and market intelligence, giving your business the power of knowledge based on fact rather than supposition, and bringing you closer to your customers and target markets.

With telemarketing at its core, BT Indirect Channels has built a unique marketing support model designed to help our partners drive their businesses forward with strategic lead marketing activities and consultancy tools.

Telemarketing for our Partners has two distinct strands, Bespoke campaigns tailored to individual company needs and the Channels Demand creation programme, Maximiser designed to generate business from key areas of the BT portfolio

'...the leads were of a standard I have grown to expect from the Astrate/BTIC service. I was impressed with their professionalism and response to any questions or queries!...
Martyn Jones, Sales Director duPré

The results speak for themselves.

Utilising a proven methodology and the expertise of our strategically selected telemarketing partner, BTIC'S Telemarketing partner of choice has achieved more than 3 times industry average response rates, generating in excess of 3,000 leads for our channel partners since the programme started in 2002.

More importantly, telemarketing has generated £12.2m worth of prospective business resulting in billed revenue (to date) exceeding £3.9 million.

The kind of results that you could benefit from.

'Although still at an early stage of the campaign we have had 100% conversion from lead to booked customer meetings'
Angus Mitchell, Sales Manager at Telindus

Guide to Telemarketing – An Introduction

The results speak for themselves

Sharing in this success doesn't have to cost a fortune either. Having negotiated preferential rates with our partner, and whether whole or partly funded from our co-op marketing budget, your business can reap the benefits of cost effective and strategically led telemarketing campaigns.

This BT 'Essential Guide to Telemarketing' is designed to dispel misconceptions surrounding telemarketing, and outline how your business can utilise BT's account managed telemarketing services, contracted on your behalf by Indirect Channels, in many ways to help deliver your company's strategic business objectives.

How can your business benefit?

BTIC's lead generation programme covers the entire portfolio of BT's services, including ADSL, Multisite Communications, SHDS, IPVPN, FrameStream, MeetMe Conferencing and call packages, Commitment and Reward. Often using a Communications Review as a consultative tool to gain interest, the programme puts selected BTIC partners like yourselves in touch with the right profile of prospects relevant to your business.

There are two ways to benefit from BTIC's lead generation programme.

Firstly, you can enrol in our Maximiser programme of ongoing lead generation, and benefit from a regular stream of leads that have been identified on behalf of BTIC then passed to our partners, like yourselves, for immediate follow up.

Secondly, working closely with your BT Account Manager and BT Marketing Manager, we can develop and implement 'bespoke' lead generation campaigns on your behalf.

Welcome to BT Indirect Channel's (MAXIMISER) Programme

As a highly skilled partner, you are ideally placed to take full advantage of BT Indirect Channel's unique lead generation programme, and create additional business for your organisation.

BTIC have developed a high-end lead generation programme designed to provide you with a regular stream of genuine communication requirements that lead to true high-value sales opportunities relevant to your core business competencies. Unlike many other vendor driven lead generation activities, our programme is a closely monitored, quality controlled, process of lead generation that results in leads that adhere to a strict criteria, delivered within an agreed timeframe.

'The telemarketing leads are progressing well, Maximiser can run for ever as far as I am concerned, it's great value.'
Julian Shaw, Director, Computerworld

How does Maximiser work?

Maximiser targets highly profiled and segmented companies who would be most responsive to a specific communications proposition, taking into consideration vertical markets and specific geographic locations relevant to the partners who will ultimately receive the leads.

The telemarketing team of dedicated BTIC agents, who are fully trained across the entire BT portfolio, prospect these profiled targets with the objective of identifying genuine business opportunities – termed priority leads or development leads – which are then passed directly onto Maximiser partners only once they have reached a genuine lead status.



Any requests for information are automatically fulfilled via post or email, and then followed up again, ensuring each and every opportunity is investigated to its furthest conclusion before handing over to you, the partner.

The quality of leads generated to date has been excellent. The depth of information provided by Astute on each prospect has enables us to open a business dialogue very quickly.'
Ian Boreham, Marketing Manager, at ONI

What should you expect from Maximiser?

Using a highly consultative approach themselves, The telemarketing agents investigate the prospect's readiness and suitability for a consultative communications review. This review is undertaken by yourselves, with the objective of identifying and recommending bandwidth efficient and cost efficient ways of improving the prospect's network.

Through detailed contact with the decision maker, the agents will highlight the prospect's current communication infrastructure resulting in a detailed 'qualification' document. This will provide you with an invaluable insight into the company and enable you to engage quickly in intelligent, relevant business and technical dialogue when following up.

BTIC's telemarketing partner are members of the DMA and have formal non-disclosure agreements in place with BTIC. NDAs can also be signed with yourselves if required.

Prior to any leads being passed to you for follow up, all parties involved with Maximiser will have agreed the exact lead criteria, thus ensuring expectations are fully met. 99% of leads generated by Maximiser for partners to date have met the agreed criteria – an enviable track record of generating leads which meet expectations and lead to new business opportunities.

'..Firstly, many thanks for involving Fairbridge in Maximiser and also the work put into the Fairbridge campaign. Both are still running here and certainly starting to bear fruit...with regards to the standard of leads we are receiving, I must congratulate the team for the fantastic effort they have put into this. The quality of information we have received from the team has been first class. The leads are clear, concise and very well qualified. I would be most grateful if you can pass these sentiments on to all involved'
Steve Olden, Fairbridge Communications

Leads developed will fall clearly into two main categories:

Priority Lead

A priority lead is when a actual connectivity requirement has been identified and qualified at the time of call. With a requirement identified, the company has agreed to receive a call from you, the partner. An expectation on the timeframe for the follow-up call is secured to discuss the review visit, and a detailed technical profile of the company is provided to enable you to prepare for the call and usually confirm an appointment. Priority leads/interests are largely dependant on the speculative timeliness of the call and therefore represent a minority of the total leads qualified.

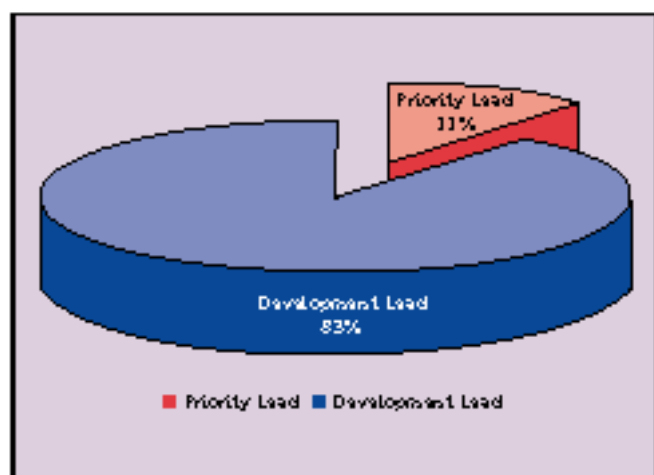


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Development Lead

A development lead is when the decision maker has shown a strong interest in improving their connectivity / having therefore a communications review, and has agreed to receive a call to discuss this in more detail. Again a suggested timeframe for the follow up call is provided. At point of call there is NO actual known connectivity requirement but it is agreed that reviewing more cost / bandwidth efficient methods of connectivity possibilities within the network would be advantageous. This is a consultative selling approach. The BTIC partner must agree to invest the time and skills to develop the 'foot in the door' and establish and build new businesses for themselves and BTIC. Again, a detailed technical profile of the company is provided to enable you to prepare for the call and secure the review visit.

The amount of priority leads you will receive will obviously vary according to the timeliness of the company's requirements, and development leads will therefore represent the larger proportion of the overall leads / interests generated during campaign activity.



What does Maximiser expect from you?

There are limited Maximiser places available. The Maximiser programme is only offered to partners who can demonstrate that they have the trained resources and capabilities to diligently follow up the leads provided. This controlled access to the programme is essential to maintain the integrity of the activity and to ensure focus on delivering real business opportunities and maximizing Return On Marketing Investment (ROMI).

In return for being a Maximiser partner, we expect:

Continual feedback

In return for becoming part of the Maximiser programme, we expect continual feedback until the lead reaches its ultimate conclusion. Feedback on leads is essential for two reasons – firstly to enable us to measure return on investment to ensure continual support for the programme, and secondly to ensure that you are provided with an ongoing supply of leads.

Timely follow up

Maximiser partners are required to follow up leads within a defined timescale and provide us with ongoing feedback. Contacting key decision makers when following up passed leads can take minimum of two to three calls, and you need to bear this in mind when scheduling the follow up of leads provided to you. The longer a follow up call is left, the harder it will be to prompt a recall of the original conversations that took place between the telemarketing agent and the prospect, so it is essential to act upon leads as soon as they are received.

Use the information provided

By using the detailed information provided to you on the leadsheet, your representative will be able to demonstrate advance knowledge about the prospect's particular requirements. If you fully understand the outcome of the initial calls made by Astute, you will meet the prospect's expectations when you make the call, and give yourselves the advantage when following up the lead.

Knowledgeable follow up

Following up the lead using a trained sales resource will ensure you get the most from the opportunity. The telemarketing agents will have identified an interest and / or requirement for a connectivity solution/review, but you can then investigate and develop the opportunity further in line with your company's own skills and competencies. Also, when BTIC's approved telemarketers make the original call, the agency's name is not used - BTIC's name is. Therefore when following up the lead, use the power of the brand BTIC in conjunction with your own company's name, presenting yourselves as a trained and authorised BTIC partner.

Bespoke Campaigns

In addition to the Maximiser programme, your own data can be used as the basis for bespoke, one-off proposition led campaigns, dedicated to your company with all resulting leads and information passed to you.

The benefits of a bespoke campaign are that the message can be specifically tailored to encompass the skills of your organisation, positioning your company with the decision maker from the very beginning. You will also benefit from the exported data at the end of the campaign, enhanced with the addition of company and contact information collated during the calling.

Any databases provided by yourselves will be de-duplicated against BT Indirect Channel's House Account list and current Partner list to avoid contacting your competitors. If ADSL is to feature in the proposition, then we can also match databases against ADSL enabled areas by postcode. Alternatively, we can source suitably profiled data specifically for your campaign.

BTIC's programme of lead generation is a two way partnership - the more your company puts in, the more you will gain.

To maximise your partnership with BTIC, work closely with your BT Account Manager and BT Marketing Manager to develop a plan of activity that directly benefit your organisation and helps you reap the rewards of genuine business opportunities.



... good news with regard to the telemarketing campaign. I now have prospected around £350k worth of business and have today won an order for 37 BT Openworld Connections... Many Thanks for all your help.'

*Tom O'Hagan, BT Account Director,
SAS Telecom Limited*

A young woman with brown hair tied back, wearing a headset with a microphone, is smiling and looking down at a laptop screen. She is wearing a pink tank top under a light-colored button-down shirt. The background is a bright, out-of-focus window.

Customer Care

Lead Generation

Exhibition Follow-up

How can telemarketing be used?

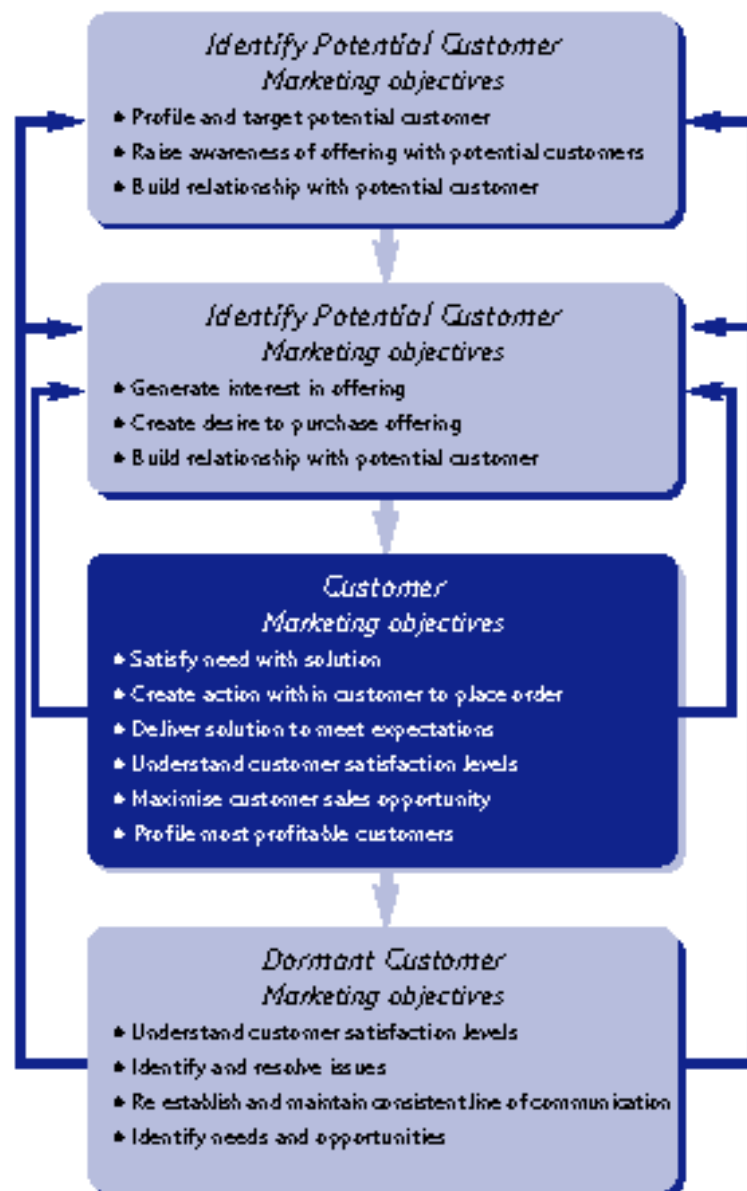
No two companies are the same, but many common requirements exist when striving to achieve a successful business. For example, most companies want to achieve these basic business objectives:

'A huge thank you to all your wonderful team for the sterling performance on the campaign...your management of and reporting for this programme have been superb. I look forward to working with you in future campaigns.'

Helen Guest, Collaborative Programme Manager, BT Retail Indirect Channels

- Attract new customers
- Increase customer loyalty
- Reduce customer attrition
- Maintain a competitive advantage
- Understand and profile intelligence on its customer and prospect bases.

The importance of these objectives can best be illustrated using a simple model that shows the stages of the sales cycle with the associated objectives:



'...I have had some verbal feedback from partners and the quality of information received is excellent. Partners are obviously please and impressed with the quality. You obviously have a great team please pass on my thanks to them.'

Martin Peters, BTIC Account Director

How can telemarketing be used?

Using the telephone at the core of our marketing activities, BT Indirect Channels has successfully helped many of our partners to achieve results driven objectives at every stage of the sales cycle.

Using the traditional sales cycle as a continuous framework, and taking each stage at a time, the following outlines how telemarketing can be used to facilitate a smooth flow of business.

1. Identify potential customers

In the early stages of a business lifecycle, many companies achieve initial success based on word of mouth recommendation, one of the best forms of new business. However, it can be risky to rely on word of mouth as your only source of new leads.

There are a number of sources of potential customers. Many people look straight to new databases for a list of targets, and overlook their own customer bases – invariably the most cost effective place to start when looking for new business. These contacts know your company, even if a long time has lapsed since they last dealt with you.

The database you use is key to the success of any direct marketing activity. No matter how fantastic your proposition is, without clean and segmented data, you can waste a lot of time and money directing your message at the wrong audience.

'All excellent – I have been in the business a while and these leads are some of the best. I am personally very pleased'
Paul Mellor Chrimes, Bailey Telecom

It has been estimated that, if left untouched, 60% of database information will be redundant within a year. By directly contacting companies, initially at reception level, BT Telemarketing can be used to clean and profile your existing customer databases, giving you an up to date foundation upon which to base your marketing communications.

If you are an established business, by profiling exactly who your existing key customers are, and then defining your key business strengths accordingly, you can model a unique proposition to proactively approach a specific and relevant target audience. For example, if your strengths lie in providing services to a particular vertical market, and you have a very profitable customer in that market, then profile their business in terms of size and infrastructure and target other companies with similar characteristics. In other words, replicate your success.

Database profiling can also be used to provide an in-depth profile of companies who you want to know more about. What are they considering and when? Who is making the decision to buy? The more intelligence you can gather about the companies you target, the more informed and relevant you will be when approaching them with a proposition.

'Very effective campaign that provided accurate information on the decision makers and the existing infrastructure of potential customers, thus generating business opportunities for our account managers to close.'
Daniel Briggs – Convergent Systems

There are several reasons why you might want to source new data for your campaign. If your business is relatively new, or you want to enter into new markets, or augment your own database with companies in a specific vertical market you will need additional contacts to target. As part of BT's Telemarketing service, we can advise you and source databases from selected and trusted sources to help ensure the success of your campaign. See 'Key Success Factors' for more information on databases, and how to segment your audience.



Before entering a new market, or launching a new product, it is critical to understand the size of the opportunity and to test your message. With a clear understanding of your objectives, a pilot telemarketing campaign will act as an invaluable tool to test your proposition and to gauge market acceptance prior to launching your full-scale campaign.

If your business involves recruiting a channel of skilled partners to help deliver your products and services, telemarketing is an excellent tool for partner recruitment. Not only can it be used to profile companies with the right skill sets, it can deliver your proposition and handle any objections simultaneously.

2. Identify needs and opportunities

Once you have tested your proposition, and have a well-profiled and segmented database, outbound telemarketing can be used to deliver a value-based proposition to both potential and existing customers.

By identifying and contacting the right decision makers with your message, telemarketing can identify companies with a potential interest in your solution. By listening carefully to the decision maker, and then asking the right kinds of questions, the level of interest in your solution can be identified, thereby providing a feed of strategic leads to fit with your own company's sales cycle.

Telemarketing is a person-to-person form of communication, and it is a lot more cost effective to identify the right kinds of companies on the telephone first, before sending highly paid sales people into companies where little or no opportunity exists. As it becomes increasingly difficult to contact key contacts, telemarketing can also offer accessibility to decision makers who would never agree to an appointment.

In many cases the ultimate objective of a telemarketing campaign is to set appointments, where a qualified company representative can visit in person to further understand the client's needs and expand on the offering. Telemarketing enables you to take your message to a larger number of potential customers in a very short time period, thus maximising the use of your sales team's time.

If properly managed and executed, seminars, briefings and conferences alike can effectively deliver company messages to a captive audience. As part of our unique marketing support service, BT can provide you with consultative advice to ensure you get an audience of the right quality. Combined with other forms of marketing communication including direct mail and Internet bulletins, our outbound telemarketing services can be successfully used to raise awareness of events and to increase attendance levels.

The follow up after an event is critical if all opportunities for business are to be identified. Did your audience understand the message? Do they have a requirement for the solutions that were proposed during the event? Again, telemarketing can be used to contact seminar attendees to find out the answers to these questions, ensuring that no opportunities are missed.

Successful marketing communication relies on consistent and relevant contact. Despite the proliferation of direct mail within the IT industry, a significant return on marketing investment can still be achieved when followed up with a structured telemarketing campaign. For example, if a prospect recalls having seen a mailer, he is more likely to enter into a conversation about its contents, and discuss whether it is relevant to his business or not. Direct mail, when combined with telemarketing, does increase response rates from both activities compared with executing the activities in isolation.

'...Nimans were very impressed with the quality of the detail returned. Whilst this activity was not directly aimed at generating leads they feel the information can help them with a more targeted approach to the base...'

Simon Rowen, BT Indirect Channels



How can telemarketing be used?

3. Maintain Customer Loyalty

With the advent of email as a quick and easy method of communication, it is all too easy to forget to pick up the phone and speak to our customers.

At the heart of maintaining customer loyalty lies an in depth understanding of customer satisfaction levels. If a customer is dissatisfied with an element of your product or service, without the opportunity to address the issue it is unlikely that they will use you again.

Conversely, if customers are highly satisfied with your company, you need to know where and how so you can replicate the experience for others. Telemarketing can be used to gather invaluable customer endorsements, an ideal tool to add credibility to your organisation and also reduce the risk factor for potential customers.

Telemarketing can be used as an objective tool to help you understand your customer's needs and wants. By developing short and engaging customer satisfaction surveys, your company can glean invaluable information that can be fed back into your planning process. Inevitably, these kinds of surveys can also yield potential leads for new business.

*'Very good activity. Communication between Astute, BT and HB Internet was excellent. Astute were always available to support, help and provide guidance on the campaign and any issues within it'.
Peter Walsh – HB Internet*

Companies can spend thousands of pounds developing their brand image, and inviting potential customers to contact them. Yet without a structured and managed approach, a potential customer can be put off at the very first stages of trying to contact your company. Encompassing all forms of response, including 0800 numbers, fax, email, web, and direct mail, a well managed inbound response management campaign will maximise your lead conversion rates, and ensure your customers, both potential and existing, experience seamless contact with your organisation.

4. Dormant Customers

When looking for new business, many companies overlook the potential goldmine of leads they already have within their own database. Maybe your dormant customers aren't aware of your new products or services, or maybe they have forgotten about what you actually do – for whatever reason buying activity has lapsed, dormant customers make an ideal target for 'new' business.

A focussed telemarketing campaign aimed at reactivating dormant accounts will improve their perception of your business and can easily yield a much higher lead ratio than a campaign that uses a completely cold database. By adopting a proactive approach, it can be relatively easy to resurrect dormant accounts, thereby reducing customer churn rates and enabling you to develop a loyal group of customers.

'This telemarketing campaign was professionally executed and exceeded our expectations. The main purpose of the exercise was to get our database to a condition that we could work with. Astute provided more in-depth information than expected and it was very accurate. The quality of leads were also of a high standard. We would definitely like to use this service again if it was made available'

Tim Wells – Ascom Marketing Manager

Why outsource telemarketing?

In an ever changing and fluctuating economic climate is it vital that your business is profitable and remains flexible enough to meet the demands of a dynamic market place.

Trying to run your own telemarketing team in house can be very resource intensive, and can easily distract you from your core business competencies. Without adequate resource in-house, telemarketing staff can quickly become demotivated and unfocussed, leaving you with a costly and unproductive overhead.

By utilising BT's marketing support services, uniquely developed for our channel partners, you can benefit from an on-demand resource to augment your existing resources. No need to worry about telephone lines, equipment, or office space. You can 'staff up' on-demand without having to recruit, train, or pay in-house employees. And you get expert consultation based on years of IT telemarketing experience gained through delivering successful campaigns time and time again.

'...campaign process was well planned and produced good leads HB Telecom will be able to close future business on...'

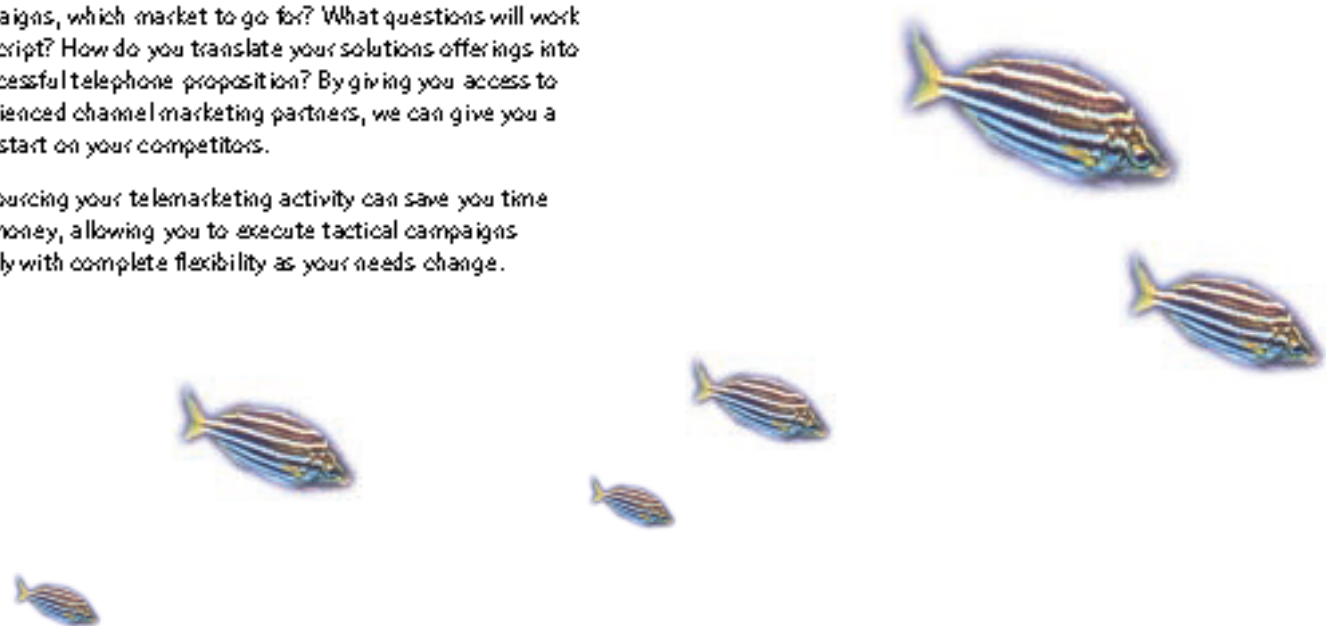
Danian Ronan, HB Telecom

'Overall it has been an excellent campaign and far exceeded CAE's expectations in terms of results. Telemarketing, as an element of the direct marketing mix was new to CAE but through the experience of utilising BT and Astute we will definitely be increasing our investment in this area. The process from BT's initial understanding of CAE's marketing requirements, to the collaborative planning by Astute, CAE and BT and the final execution by Astute simply delivered results.'

Justin Harlin Commercial Manager CAE

It is easy to underestimate the amount of planning and management required to run your own telemarketing campaigns, which market to go for? What questions will work in a script? How do you translate your solutions offerings into a successful telephone proposition? By giving you access to experienced channel marketing partners, we can give you a head start on your competitors.

Outsourcing your telemarketing activity can save you time and money, allowing you to execute tactical campaigns quickly with complete flexibility as your needs change.





Enterprise Management

Partner Recruitment

Customer Satisfaction

Why use BT's approved telemarketing services?

In the same way as there are headaches associated with managing your own internal telemarketing team, managing an external telemarketing agency can be equally demanding. Without a trusted telemarketing supplier, you can easily lose control of your campaign objectives, and fail to achieve the results you were looking for.

Like all companies, you want to see a return on your marketing investment, and with a plethora of telemarketing agencies to choose from, it can be a daunting and costly task to find an effective agency that consistently delivers results.

BT Telemarketing Consultancy

Our bespoke telemarketing consultancy service is designed to help you focus your company's strategic direction, and will also enable you to improve customer care and maximise the business opportunities available to you throughout the sales cycle.

Like you, we want to see a return on our marketing investment, and we would only recommend a partner with expertise in the IT sector and with a proven track record of delivering results.

'Modern are very happy with the quantity and quality of the leads generated and wouldn't hesitate to recommend or use Astute's/BT's telemarketing services again.'

Adrian Barnard

MD Modern Communications

Unique Business Model

Selected only after winning a stringent, results driven tender process involving ten other telemarketing agencies, BT utilise the services of a specialist telemarketing partner to deliver our campaigns and those of our business partners.

The agency contracted by BT as an approved supplier, has developed a unique business model using trained IT specialists as a dynamic, knowledgeable and consistent resource to execute effective campaigns. The agency has in excess of 20 years experience within its management team. This includes a proposition director who holds full Cisco CCDP and Nortel Networks Expert technical accreditations. His previous roles include Pre-Sales Manager at a UK division of a global Value Added Distributor and Senior Network Consultant for a Cisco Gold Partner and Nortel Networks ESP.

'I found Astute and the BT Marketing Team to be professional and efficient. Astute took time to understand our business and exactly what we were looking for as a result of this marketing exercise. Given the opportunity I would like to run the exercise again and Astute will of course be considered for our future telemarketing activity'

James Barber- Harlequin Solutions

What is unique about BT Telemarketing Services?

Unlike many agency staff, the skilled personnel used by our partner are information hungry, and are technically capable of holding conversations with senior decision makers. Given their technological background, they are trained to take conversations beyond the limitations of a traditional telemarketing script, and can spot opportunities outside of their remit, where a prospect indicates they have another need.

One of the biggest complaints about many telemarketing agencies is the quality of the leads provided. Based on the information intelligently gained from the telephone conversation, our partner will deliver fully qualified leads, giving your sales teams a head start when contacting the prospect.

Because our partner ONLY undertakes campaigns related to the IT industry, specifically networking and communications, and the telemarketers understand the technology they are talking about, they consistently deliver higher than average conversion rates.

In a competitive environment, it is often essential to react quickly and proactively with a strategic market proposition. By focusing solely on marketing for the IT channel, your campaigns can be executed within short time frames by a dynamic pool of trained and knowledgeable telemarketers who can hit the ground running.

The agency has invested in training fifteen BT specialist agents working within a telemarketing unit. Each agent has been trained on BT's solutions portfolio including Advanced Data Services (ADS) and Commitment.

'Delighted with the overall success of the campaign so far, the support received from BTIC marketing and Astute is first class, the content of the reports is really good, the best seen. The leads are exactly what they (Central Telecom) were looking for and they've received more than expected.'

Andy Brain, BTIC Account Manager

How does telemarketing help within the channel?

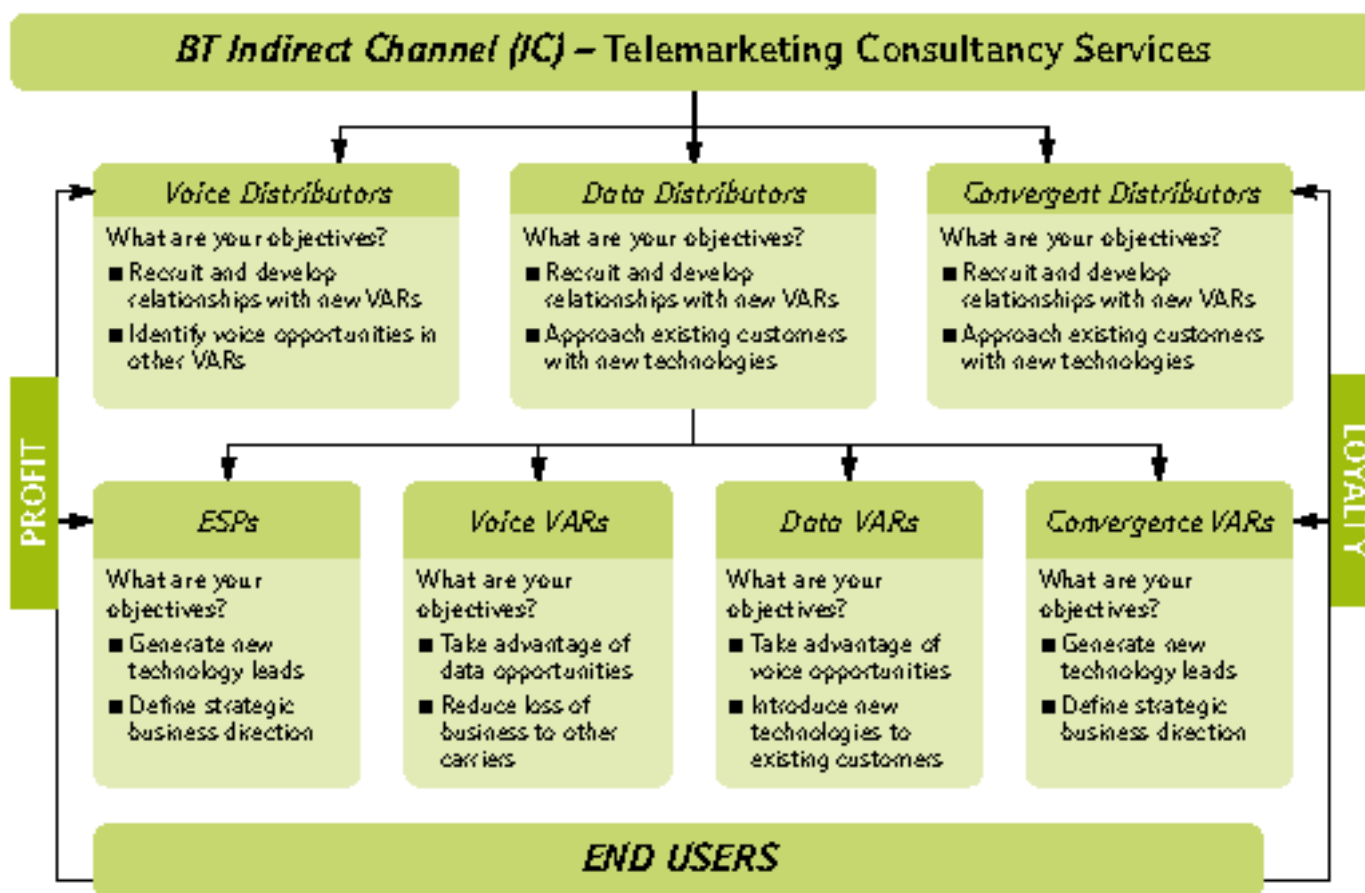
The traditional channel model has changed, and is ever changing. By working with BT Indirect Channels, you can differentiate your business and generate additional streams of revenue from new and existing customers.

Before examining specific objectives for your type of business, here are some of the common business objectives that telemarketing can assist with.

What is your objective?	How can telemarketing help?
We need to reactivate dormant customers	Contact your dormant customers with a reminder proposition and fact find as to the accounts current activity
We need to renew existing and dormant contracts	Contact customer before contract lapses, and renew before expiry
We need to focus our efforts on more profitable accounts	Profile profitable accounts and replicate, source a database and target with your business proposition profitable accounts
We need to differentiate ourselves from our competitors	Develop a unique proposition, integrate into your marketing communications and deliver via telemarketing
We require more leads for our sales teams	Agree lead criteria, develop proposition, target prospects and identify interest in solution
We need new streams of revenue	Research new markets before entering, test and develop proposition

Depending on the type of channel partner you are, different business objectives can be achieved using telemarketing. The following chart outlines the

particular business objectives that BT Telemarketing Services be used to achieve depending on your role within the channel.



How various channel partners used telemarketing to achieve their objectives?

PARTNER TYPE	OBJECTIVE	ACTIVITY	RESULTS
Voice Distributor	To increase sales of data services into traditional voice customer base.	500 Decision Maker telemarketing campaign.	In excess of 20% lead conversion. £80k plus sales to date.
Data Distributor	Wanted to increase its active BT reseller base.	Conducted new business lead generation into a cold base of 500 voice and data resellers.	Generated 70 reseller leads of which 6 had immediate Carrier services requirement at time of call.
Data VAR	Midlands base voice VAR approached Astute to conduct a lead generation campaign into its maintained PBX base to identify BT services opportunities including, where appropriate, Commitment.	The campaign offered a free 'communications audit'. Secondary, objective was to question and report back on the services provided by the VAR.	500 Decision Maker campaign generated 100 sales leads.
ESP Partner	Generate market interest in a new packaged content management solution including the application, hosting and internet access options	500 decision maker lead generation campaign.	500 Decision Maker campaign generated 50 sales leads. Considered a highly successful campaign introducing a new technology/proposition to the market



A woman with blonde hair, wearing a black headset with a microphone, is shown in profile. She is pointing her right index finger at a computer monitor. The monitor displays a blue screen with a grid of small white dots. The background is a bright, out-of-focus office environment.

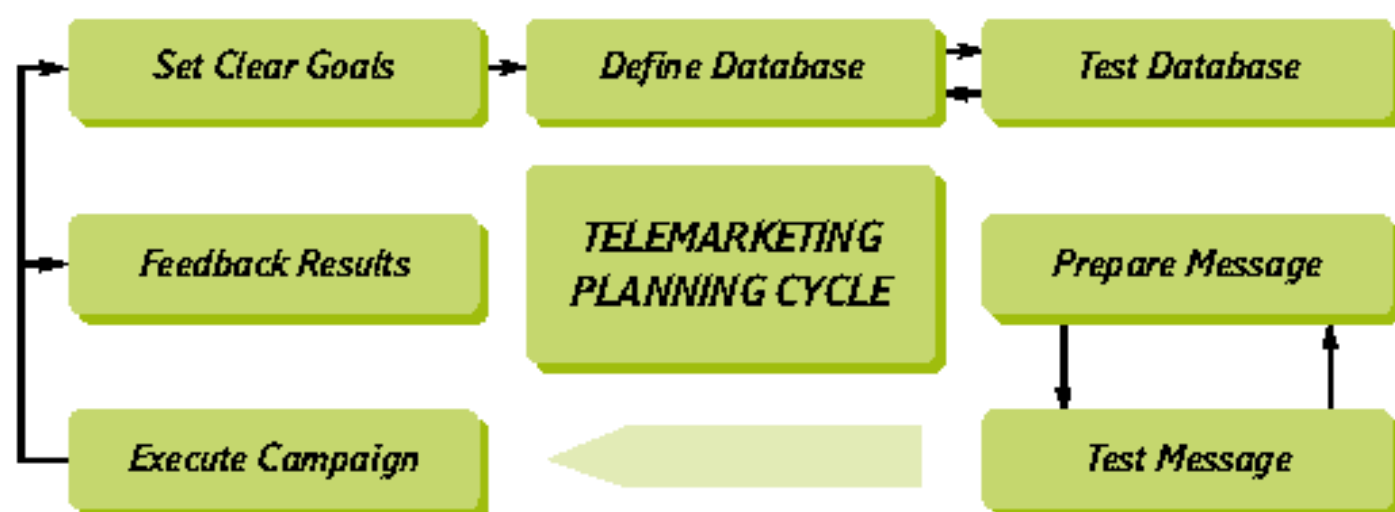
Database Profiling

Market Testing

Repeat Business

Inbound Response Management

What are the key factors to a successful telemarketing campaign?



'I have been delighted with the standard of lead we have received to date. Xpert hope to deliver a full range of bandwidth services & BT Commitment deals as part of this programme'

*Jade Parkinson-Hill,
Marketing Manager at Xpert Systems*

There are several critical steps to consider when planning a successful telemarketing campaign.

Looking at these stages individually, here are some guidelines to consider when planning your campaign.

1. Set Clear Goals

Before you begin your telemarketing campaign, you must first determine your specific goals. Unclear goals and indecisive strategies are guaranteed to produce disappointing results.

Clear campaign goals can be set in terms of:

- Realistic No of leads / responses expected from telephone campaign
- Conversion rate
- Average project value
- Return on investment
- Timescales for achievement

It is also critical at this planning stage to agree the following:

- Responsibilities for follow up
- Information to be sent out on request
- Format of campaign output information e.g. Word, Access

Only by setting clear goals, will you be able to measure the success of your campaign. Bear in mind that goals need to be specific, measurable, and realistic.

Before commencing any campaign, clearly define what criteria a lead needs to meet.

In general 'requests for information' should not be classified as a genuine lead. For example:

Lead

Requirement within next 3 months with budget allocated
Requirement within 3-6 months with budget allocated
Requirement within 6-12 months with budget allocated

Information request

e.g. no budget allocated, but information gathering

By clearly setting the definitions of what a lead will be in advance of the campaign, you will be able to measure the outputs, and review the results versus your objectives.

What are the key factors to a successful telemarketing campaign?

2. Define database

Your calling list is key to the success of any campaign.

Does your database match your message?

Before preparing any kind of proposition it is vital to identify the buying pattern for the product or service, and to understand the make up of decision-making process i.e. what is the sales cycle? Who are the key influencers and decision makers in this buying process? Once you have fully prepared this information you can source a database that corresponds to your profile.

If you are following up on a direct mail campaign, your calling list obviously needs to be the same as your mailing list, and you need to use a list that has telephone numbers! All obvious things to consider, but often overlooked.

Where do you source a database?

There are a number of sources of data you can draw upon. If using your own database, consider how up to date it is. BT IC will organise for a telemarketing resource to make a first pass at the data to clean it and identify the correct decision maker. This can often be done by speaking to someone at reception level, and will ensure that any further campaign activity, e.g. direct mail, is directed at a clean list of contacts.

If your campaign demands specific criteria from a database that you do not hold in house, you can rent one from a list broker. Data can be purchased in the following ways:

- Single use mailing only
- Single use mailing and one time telemarketing
- 12 month rental
- Outright purchase

You might ask why can't you buy a mailing list on single use only basis, and then continue to use it. Unfortunately it is not that easy – list brokers will imbed what they term as 'seed records' into the data, which if contacted will alert the list broker to abuse of the licence agreement you paid for. You can also pay to receive regular database updates to keep your records fresh.

What database criteria should you use?

Take all the businesses in the UK. You don't want to target every single one with your message – you only want to target those companies that meet your profiled target audience to which the message will be relevant.

Databases can be segmented using a number of criteria that should be clearly defined when planning your campaign. Database intelligence has increased significantly over the last few years, and you can now select data based on any or all of the following criteria depending on your objective:

- Size of company based on number of employees or turnover
- Geographical location of company
- Vertical market e.g. manufacturing or finance
- Job title of decision maker e.g. IT Director or Network Manager
- Technological infrastructure e.g. number of PCs or make of PBX installed

'The telemarketing has definitely been worthwhile giving me visibility of who the customers are and what they have, the quality of information is superb.'
Martyn Jones – Sales Director, Duprè

Be aware that the more detailed the criteria you specify to segment your market by, the more expensive the data will be as it has taken longer to research. Whenever you purchase a database from an unknown source, always ask for a realistic sample (about 10 names on average) of records for no charge, and phone the sample companies to test for data validity.

Also find out what returns policy your database supplier has. For example, if you have heaps of 'gone away' companies at the end of a campaign, you will want some compensation! Be aware that database companies will normally limit their liability to replacement records, and will not compensate you for loss of business or expenditure on design or print, reinforcing the point it is vital to test your data before hand.

'I would like to thank you for your swift and accurate responses to my requests. I have been impressed with the quality of the campaign leads. I have confirmed to all seminar registrants now and so far, touch wood, have had no drop outs'
Lucy Mitchell,
European Marketing Manager,
Princeton Consulting

3. Prepare your message

It is very important to prepare for the conversations that will take place between the telemarketers and the prospects. Traditional telemarketing agencies will work to a tight script and stumble should a conversation deviate from the information they have in front of them. As your BT Telemarketing partner, we would recommend that a 'call guidance instrument' is used, which gives the telemarketers all the tools they need to intelligently identify if an opportunity exists.

Following an extensive briefing, and based on extensive experience in IT telemarketing, our telemarketing partner will help you develop an effective script.

Another critical success factor to any telemarketing campaign is to develop a 'proposition with teeth' – e.g. something unique to the campaign that is of value to the recipient. Examples of this would be a free half days consultancy, or a network health check for example. In other words, something which will differentiate you from your competition while on the call and provide the prospect the emotional commitment to progress the call to the next action in the sales cycle.

Once you have prepared a solid proposition, you need to brief and train the telemarketing team and arm them with any relevant information they might need to execute the campaign. Your input at the early stages of a telemarketing campaign is critical, as there is an initial learning curve involved in any new activity. It is a proven fact, that the more you can assist the telemarketers at the beginning, the greater the results. We actively encourage you to come visit your BT telemarketing partner – meet the team, provide and briefing/training session and give them the benefit of your experience.



What are the key factors to a successful telemarketing campaign?

5. Execute campaign

Once your campaign is underway, we actively encourage an open channel of feedback between the telemarketers and the sales people who will be following up the leads. This will ensure that any opportunities are uncovered, where a traditional agency may not explore the lead to its full potential because they do not have enough information or knowledge.

Once a campaign has been planned and tested, the biggest key to its success will be to maximise momentum for the duration of the campaign. Simple incentives can be put in place to encourage telemarketers to achieve the best results. Providing the telemarketers with positive feedback from any leads can also very motivating when cold calling.

6. Feedback and analyse results

Feedback should not just happen at the end of a campaign. A continuous loop of feedback, utilising the knowledge gained throughout planning and execution, will ensure that your campaign is a dynamic knowledge sharing process.

When the campaign is finished, review the activity and the results in line with your initial campaign goals.

Don't forget that in addition to the leads you have received, there will be a group of prospects that have requested a call in a few months time. Don't waste the effort that has been put into gaining these information requests – ensure that they are allocated as a task to either your telemarketing partner at a later date, or given to a sales person internally.

Hopefully, this Guide to Telemarketing has outlined how your business can deploy telemarketing in many ways to help meet your business objectives.

To find out how to utilise telemarketing as a resource for your business, contact your BT Account Manager or BT Marketing Specialist.

'We have built a powerful, strategic relationship with BT which has been complemented by the professional, thorough and responsive help we have received from Astute. This forms a strong basis for a continuing and powerful business relationship.'

*Nick Templeton,
Rocom's Network First Manager*



